First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: Tuesday - Friday: 9am- 2pm
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours:
Friday 9:30am-2:30pm and by Appointment
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.
Please note that Monday is Pastor Jessica's day off.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

July 12, 2026

10 A.M.

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Stephen McLaughlin, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555

info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

Seventh Sunday after Pentecost July 12, 2026

We Gather as God's People

Centering Words:

I had a dream I was awake and I woke up to find myself asleep.
— Stan Laurel

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude *Morning Has Broken* Gaelic Melody

Welcome and Announcements

Sung Call To Worship *Here in This Place*

Holy One, may your presence here open our minds.
May your Spirit among us help us to find
You are rising up now like a fountain of Grace
From the Holy Ground.
Here in this place. Here in this place.

Morning Prayer [1] **(Unison)**

God who gathers us together, we delight to be in community with you and one another. Let your word be proclaimed in truth. Let us burst into songs that reflect the depths of our spirits. May our prayers be formed in your name and granted by your wisdom. May we know you, Divine Mystery, and ourselves better and deeper because we have entered your presence as a community of faithful, questioning, and hope-seeking participants in your kin-dom. Amen.

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

This service is made possible with the generous participation of:

Greeters: Ira Wilkens

Scripture Reader: Doug Klette

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*Please Stand If You Are Able

[1] UCC, Worship Ways

Music, Copyright permissions: CCLI #4799426 and SJMP #14586

July 26
Special Offering:
Our Church's Wider MIssion (OCWM)

The 4500 congregations of the United Church of Christ covenant together to put God's love into action in our communities and across the world.

In isolation, no single congregation can completely answer God's call to love. Together we are a bold witness to God's extravagant love for all. We share resources to bring our vision to life. Gifts from congregations like ours to OCWM Basic Support make it possible for our Conferences and the National Ministries to strengthen local churches and leaders and engage us in mission well beyond our community.

Most of our OCWM Basic Support dollars remain in our Conferences to help local congregations thrive. Direct support in Conferences comes through leadership initiatives, such as communities of practice, committees on ministry, and one-on-one mentoring. Conferences also share in congregational vitality work. This includes conflict transformation, resourcing leaders as they reimagine ministry, and grants to churches.

The National Ministries of the UCC, a crucial partner of our Conference and each congregation, helps us put love into action, especially through ministry that no one congregation could do alone.



HYMN*

Joyful, Joyful We Adore You (1,3,4) NCH 4

PRAYER OF TRANSFORMATION [1] **(UNISON)**

Holy One, we incline our hearts toward you, but the concerns of the world and challenges of daily living pull us away. Keep us grounded in your promises, your purposes, your power, and your presence. Reorient us on the road of liberation, belonging, and communal care so that not only do we receive the gift of transformation, we companion with siblings, neighbors, and even enemies in your work of making all things new. Remove the misleading veil that disguises sufficiency with scarcity. Sustain us with being satisfied with enough and abundance materially while continuing to thirst for righteousness so that all may be well. In you, we hope and believe. Amen.

PAUSE FOR REFLECTION
ASSURANCE OF GOD'S LOVE
PASSING OF THE PEACE

THE MESSAGE

TIME WITH CHILDREN OF ALL AGES
SPECIAL MUSIC
Lascia ch'io Pianga arr. Conrady G.F. Haendel

SCRIPTURE READING
Matthew 13:1-9; 18-23
CONTEMPORARY READING
Sowing Clover Wendell Berry

REFLECTION *Believers, Seekers, and Doubters*

Hymn*

For the Healing of the Nations (1,3,4) NCH 576

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns

Prayer of the People ~

Lord's Prayer

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen.

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow,
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn*

Go Now In Peace

Benediction

Postlude

Eternal God, Whose Power Upholds G.F. Haendel

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖

Announcements:

A Special Note of Gratitude from All of Us at FCC:

★ Sue Powers - Thank You for all the support and care you give to the FCC community!

Open-Mic and Community Pot-Luck
July 18, 7-9pm
Sing- Play- Read- Recite- Tell a story- or just sit back, relax, and enjoy!

July 25
2-4pm
Picnic @ Holiday House
with Jessica Pecor and Heather Miller!

The AHA Art Club:
Thursdays at Noon
Looking for a creative outlet? Join us. Instruction, materials, and good cheer available. No experience necessary. Donations welcome.

Mindful Awareness with Jonathan:
Thursday mornings 8-9am - Free
In the Sanctuary
Explore present-centered awareness and insight through acceptance and letting go. All are welcome.

ZOOM Bible Study: On vacation!

Wifi:
Sanctuary: sanctuary123

